Twice the squares, not the squares: remainders modulo 4 in a theta-type series

A disproof of the conjecture in OEIS A380680, and the corrected statement

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Abstract

The OEIS entry A380680, contributed by Paul D. Hanna, is the power series $A(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}\big((2-x^n)/(1-2x^n)\big)^n = 1 + 4x + 6x^2 + 12x^3 + 32x^4 + \cdots$, a variant of the classical theta series $\theta(x) = \sum_n x^{n^2}$. The entry conjectures that, for $n > 0$, the coefficient $a(n)$ leaves remainder 2 on division by 4 exactly when n is a perfect square, and is divisible by 4 otherwise. We show that this conjecture is false: $a(1) = 4$ and $a(2) = 6$, as the published terms already show. We then prove the correct statement: for $n > 0$, $a(n)$ leaves remainder 2 exactly when n is twice a perfect square ($n = 2, 8, 18, 32, \ldots$), and $a(n)$ is divisible by 4 otherwise. Equivalently, $A(x) \equiv \theta(x^2) \pmod 4$. The proof takes a few lines. The results have also been checked by computer and proved formally in the Lean proof assistant.

How this paper was produced. This paper reports the result of an autonomous AI research effort. ChatGPT (OpenAI), using the GPT-6 model with Pro reasoning and working from prompts by Dev D. Goyal, found the proof, wrote its Lean 4 formalization, and wrote a first draft of the paper. Dev D. Goyal chose the problems and asked for checks and revisions, but did not supply proof ideas. Claude Opus 5.5, used with Claude Code, then checked the work independently: it rebuilt the formal proofs from source and confirmed that they rely on no unproved assumptions, recomputed the sequence from its definition and tested every claim against the published data, and read every step of the proofs. It also rewrote this paper for clarity. Dev D. Goyal has verified the results and is responsible for them. The paper has not been peer reviewed. The section "About this paper" at the end gives the details.

1 Introduction

1.1 The sequence

The *On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences* (OEIS) [4] is a large public database of integer sequences, used by mathematicians and scientists to identify sequences and to record what is known about them. Many entries also record *conjectures*: patterns that the contributor observed in the data but could not prove.

This paper is about entry A380680 [1], contributed by Paul D. Hanna in February 2025. It reads:

```
G.f.  A(x) = Sum_{n=-oo..+oo} x^(n^2) * (2 - x^n)^n/(1 - 2*x^n)^n.

The term x^(n^2) * (2 - x^n)^n/(1 - 2*x^n)^n is invariant under sign
reversal of n.
```

— OEIS A380680, Paul D. Hanna, February 2025

Here "G.f." stands for *generating function*: the series $A(x) = \sum_{n\geq 0} a(n)\, x^n$ whose coefficients are the terms of the sequence, and `Sum_{n=-oo..+oo}` is a sum over all integers n. This series is given by an explicit formula: the right-hand side does not involve A. Using the symmetry noted in the entry, the sum over all integers can be folded into a sum over the positive integers (Lemma 2.1 below with $U = 2$), and the definition becomes

$$A = 1 + 2\,\Sigma(2), \qquad \text{where} \qquad \Sigma(2) = \sum_{j\geq 1} x^{j^2} \Big(\frac{2 - x^j}{1 - 2x^j}\Big)^j. \tag{1}$$

Here 2 stands for the constant series. This one-sided form is formula (2) of the entry, and it is the form we work with.

The first terms, starting at $n = 0$, are 1, 4, 6, 12, 32, 48, 120, 192, 450, 784, 1704, 3072, 6624, 12288, ...

The sum in the definition looks like the classical *theta series* $\theta(x) = \sum_n x^{n^2} = 1 + 2x + 2x^4 + 2x^9 + \cdots$ (Section 2), except that each term x^{n^2} carries an extra factor. We call such sums *theta-type sums*. A companion entry by the same author, OEIS A380060 [2], contributed on the same day, defines a series A by an implicit equation, with A itself in place of the constant 2 inside the sum, and states the same conjecture word for word. For that entry the conjecture is true; it is treated in a companion paper in the same collection [9].

1.2 The question

The entry contains the following conjecture.

> `Conjecture: for n > 0, a(n) == 2 (mod 4) iff n is a square, and a(n) is divisible by 4 when n is nonsquare.`
>
> — OEIS A380680, Paul D. Hanna, February 2025

Here `a(n) == 2 (mod 4)` means that $a(n)$ leaves remainder 2 on division by 4. So, for $n > 0$, the conjecture says that the terms with remainder 2 modulo 4 are exactly those at the perfect squares $n = 1, 4, 9, 16, \ldots$. The table shows the remainders of the first 48 terms, and marks with a dot the perfect squares and the numbers of the form $2j^2$.

n	0	1	**2**	3	4	5	6	7	**8**	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
$a(n)$ mod 4	1	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
$n = j^2$		•			•					•						
$n = 2j^2$			•						•							

n	16	17	**18**	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
$a(n)$ mod 4	0	0	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
$n = j^2$	•									•						
$n = 2j^2$			•													

n	**32**	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47
$a(n)$ mod 4	**2**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
$n = j^2$					•											
$n = 2j^2$	•															

The data contradict the conjecture at once: $a(1) = 4$ is divisible by 4 although 1 is a square, and $a(2) = 6$ leaves remainder 2 although 2 is not a square. Instead, the remainder 2 occurs exactly at $n = 2, 8, 18, 32$, which are twice the squares $1, 4, 9, 16$. These columns are printed in bold.

1.3 What this paper proves

The conjecture is false (Corollary 3.2): already $a(1) = 4$ and $a(2) = 6$ contradict it.

Main result (Theorem 3.1). *For every $n > 0$, $a(n) \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ if n is twice a perfect square, and $a(n)$ is divisible by 4 otherwise.* Equivalently,

$$A(x) \equiv \theta(x^2) = 1 + 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{2j^2} \pmod 4.$$

The key observation is that, modulo 2, the factor $(2 - x^j)/(1 - 2x^j)$ is simply x^j, because 2 becomes 0. So the j-th term $x^{j^2}((2 - x^j)/(1 - 2x^j))^j$ becomes $x^{j^2} \cdot x^{j^2} = x^{2j^2}$: the exponents are doubled.

1.4 What was known

The entry records the folded form of the sum (its formula (2), our equation (2)) and two further rewritings of it. The entry does not note that its own data contradict the conjecture. We are not aware of an earlier proof or disproof of the conjecture.

1.5 Why it is interesting

The theta series is a central object of number theory, and Hanna's sums are deformations of it: each term x^{n^2} is multiplied by a complicated factor. One may ask how much of the arithmetic of the theta series survives the deformation. For the remainders modulo 4 the answer turns out to be simple: modulo 4, Hanna's sums are again theta series (Section 6). The two companion entries also make a useful pair of examples. They look almost the same, their conjectures are stated in the same words, and yet the conjecture is true for A380060 and false for A380680. The proofs show exactly where the difference comes from: replacing A by 2 inside the sum changes the factor $(U - x^j)/(1 - x^jU)$, modulo 2, from 1 to x^j.

1.6 How to read this paper

Section 2 explains the few notions we need: power series, remainders, the theta series, and how to make sense of a sum over all integers. Section 3 states the results precisely, and Section 4 proves them; the proofs are short. Section 5 describes how the results were checked, by computer and by a formal proof in Lean. Section 6 discusses the scope of the result and a generalization.

2 Background

This section collects the definitions and facts used later. Readers who know formal power series and congruences can skip it and return when needed.

2.1 Power series as bookkeeping

A *formal power series* is a way of storing an infinite sequence of numbers $u_0, u_1, u_2, \ldots$ in one object,

$$U(x) = u_0 + u_1 x + u_2 x^2 + u_3 x^3 + \cdots .$$

The letter x is only a placeholder that keeps the terms apart. We never substitute a number for x, so the question of whether the series "converges" never arises; a power series is simply its list of coefficients. We write $[x^n]\,U = u_n$ for the coefficient of x^n in U. Two series are equal when all their coefficients are equal.

Series are added coefficient by coefficient and multiplied like polynomials:

$$[x^n]\,(UV) = u_0 v_n + u_1 v_{n-1} + \cdots + u_n v_0.$$

Each coefficient of a product is a finite sum, so everything is well defined. For example, $(1-x)(1+x+x^2+x^3+\cdots) = 1$, because all the other terms cancel. So $1+x+x^2+\cdots$ is the *multiplicative inverse* of $1-x$, and we write it as $\frac{1}{1-x}$. In the same way, every series D whose constant term is 1 has exactly one multiplicative inverse $\frac{1}{D}$. Its coefficients can be computed one at a time from $D \cdot \frac{1}{D} = 1$, using only additions, subtractions and multiplications. Every fraction in this paper has a denominator of this kind, so it stands for an honest power series.

Two more pieces of notation. We write $U = O(x^d)$ when all coefficients of U below degree d are zero. So $U - V = O(x^d)$ means that U and V agree up to degree $d-1$. A series of the form $x + u_2 x^2 + u_3 x^3 + \cdots$, with constant term 0 and coefficient of x equal to 1, is called *normalized*.

2.2 Remainders and congruences

For an integer $m \geq 2$ we write $a \equiv b \pmod{m}$ ("a is congruent to b modulo m") when $a - b$ is divisible by m, that is, when a and b leave the same remainder after division by m. For example, $17 \equiv 5 \pmod{4}$, since both leave remainder 1, and $-3 \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$. The remainder of a on division by m is called its *residue* modulo m; it is one of $0, 1, \ldots, m-1$. Saying that a is odd is the same as saying $a \equiv 1 \pmod{2}$.

Residues can be added and multiplied consistently, as on a clock. The residues $0, 1, \ldots, m-1$ with this "clock arithmetic" form a number system written $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$. When $m = p$ is a prime we also write $\mathbb{F}_p$. In $\mathbb{F}_2 = \{0, 1\}$ we have $1 + 1 = 0$, so adding and subtracting are the same thing.

For power series with integer coefficients, $U \equiv V \pmod{m}$ means that *every* coefficient of $U - V$ is divisible by m. Equivalently, the two series become equal when every coefficient is replaced by its residue; we call this *reducing* the series modulo m. The key fact is simple:

Reduction modulo m is compatible with all the operations above. To reduce a sum, a product, a substitution, or an inverse, we may reduce the ingredients first and then compute with clock arithmetic. This holds because every coefficient of the result is obtained from finitely many coefficients of the ingredients by adding, subtracting and multiplying, and these operations are compatible with remainders.

2.3 The theta series

The *theta series* is the power series

$$\theta(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2} = 1 + 2x + 2x^4 + 2x^9 + 2x^{16} + \cdots .$$

The sum runs over all integers n: positive, negative and zero. The terms for n and $-n$ are equal, and $n = 0$ gives 1, so

$$\theta(x) = 1 + 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{j^2}.$$

So the coefficient of x^n in θ is the number of integers whose square is n: it is 1 for $n = 0$, it is 2 when n is a positive perfect square (the two square roots $\pm j$), and it is 0 otherwise. In particular, for $n > 0$ the coefficient of x^n in $\theta(x)$ is 2 if n is a square and 0 if it is not. Replacing x by x^2 gives $\theta(x^2) = 1 + 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{2j^2} = 1 + 2x^2 + 2x^8 + 2x^{18} + \cdots$, whose nonzero coefficients sit at twice the squares.

The theta series goes back to Jacobi, and it is one of the basic objects of number theory. For example, the coefficient of x^n in $\theta(x)^k$ is the number of ways to write n as a sum of k squares of integers, counting order and signs; see [3].

2.4 The two-sided sum

Hanna's definitions are sums over all integers n, and for negative n the terms contain negative powers of x. To make sense of them we use *formal Laurent series*: series that may also contain finitely many negative powers of x, such as $x^{-2} + 3 + x + x^2 + \cdots$. They are added and multiplied like power series. With rational coefficients, every nonzero Laurent series has a multiplicative inverse: write it as $c\,x^{-k}(1 + \cdots)$ with $c \neq 0$ and invert each factor (the factor $1 + \cdots$ has constant term 1, so it can be inverted as in the previous subsection).

For a power series U and an integer $j \geq 1$ we write

$$Q_j(U) = \frac{U - x^j}{1 - x^j U}.$$

The denominator has constant term 1, so $Q_j(U)$ is an honest power series, and it has integer coefficients if U has.

Lemma 2.1 (Folding the sum)**.** *Let U be a power series with rational coefficients and nonzero constant term. For every $j \geq 1$, the term with index $n = -j$ of the sum $\sum_n x^{n^2}\big((U - x^n)/(1 - x^n U)\big)^n$ is equal to the term with index $n = j$:*

$$x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{U - x^{-j}}{1 - x^{-j}U}\Big)^{-j} = x^{j^2}\,Q_j(U)^j.$$

Consequently the two-sided sum is a power series, and

$$\sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}\Big(\frac{U - x^n}{1 - x^n U}\Big)^n = 1 + 2\,\Sigma(U), \qquad \text{where} \qquad \Sigma(U) = \sum_{j\geq 1} x^{j^2}\,Q_j(U)^j. \tag{2}$$

Proof. Both $U - x^{-j}$ and $1 - x^{-j}U$ are nonzero Laurent series (the first contains the term $-x^{-j}$, and the second is not zero because U has a constant term and so is not x^j), so the fraction and its inverse make sense. A negative exponent means: invert, then raise to the power j. So the left side is

$$x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{1 - x^{-j}U}{U - x^{-j}}\Big)^j = x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{x^j - U}{x^j U - 1}\Big)^j = x^{j^2}\Big(\frac{U - x^j}{1 - x^j U}\Big)^j,$$

where we multiplied the numerator and the denominator by x^j, and then changed the sign of both. The term with $n = 0$ is 1. Pairing $n = j$ with $n = -j$ gives (2). Finally, the term with index j is x^{j^2} times a power series, so only the finitely many j with $j^2 \leq n$ affect the coefficient of x^n; this is why the infinite sum is a well-defined power series. □

The OEIS entry notes the symmetry of Lemma 2.1 ("invariant under sign reversal of n") and records the folded form as its formula (2). In the one-sided form no negative powers and no division occur, so it makes sense with coefficients in any number system, including the clock arithmetic $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$.

2.5 Doubling modulo 4

Lemma 2.2. *Let U and V be power series with integer coefficients. If $U \equiv V \pmod 2$, then $2U \equiv 2V \pmod 4$.*

Proof. Every coefficient of $U - V$ is even, so every coefficient of $2U - 2V = 2(U - V)$ is divisible by 4. □

In words: *to know twice a series modulo 4, it is enough to know the series modulo 2.* The sums in question are multiplied by 2, and this is what makes the proofs below so short.

3 Results

Theorem 3.1. *The series A defined by (1) satisfies*

$$A(x) \equiv \theta(x^2) = 1 + 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{2j^2} = 1 + 2x^2 + 2x^8 + 2x^{18} + \cdots \pmod 4.$$

Consequently, for every $n > 0$:

- *$a(n) \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ if $n = 2j^2$ for some integer $j \geq 1$, and*
- *$a(n)$ is divisible by 4 otherwise.*

Corollary 3.2. *(a) $a(1) = 4$ and $a(2) = 6$. Hence both parts of the conjecture are false: 1 is a square but $a(1)$ is divisible by 4, and 2 is not a square but $a(2)$ is not divisible by 4.*

(b) More precisely, for $n > 0$ the conjecture predicts the wrong remainder exactly when n is a perfect square or twice a perfect square, and the right remainder (namely 0) for all other n.

4 Proofs

The idea in brief. Modulo 2 the number 2 is 0, so the factor $(2 - x^j)/(1 - 2x^j)$ becomes $-x^j/1$, which is x^j because $-1 \equiv 1 \pmod 2$. Hence the j-th term of $\Sigma(2)$ is $x^{j^2} \cdot x^{j^2} = x^{2j^2}$ modulo 2. Since $\Sigma(2)$ is multiplied by 2, knowing it modulo 2 is enough to know A modulo 4 (Lemma 2.2).

Proof of Theorem 3.1. Reduction modulo 2 is compatible with sums, products, powers and inverses, so to reduce $Q_j(2) = (2 - x^j)/(1 - 2x^j)$ we may first reduce the ingredients. The number 2 becomes 0, so

$$Q_j(2) \equiv \frac{0 - x^j}{1 - 0} = -x^j \equiv x^j \pmod 2,$$

and hence

$$x^{j^2} Q_j(2)^j \equiv x^{j^2} (x^j)^j = x^{2j^2} \pmod 2.$$

Summing over j gives $\Sigma(2) \equiv \sum_{j\geq 1} x^{2j^2} \pmod 2$. By Lemma 2.2, $2\Sigma(2) \equiv 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{2j^2} \pmod 4$, and so

$$A = 1 + 2\Sigma(2) \equiv 1 + 2\sum_{j\geq 1} x^{2j^2} = \theta(x^2) \pmod 4.$$

Different $j \geq 1$ give different exponents $2j^2$, so for $n > 0$ the coefficient of x^n in $\theta(x^2)$ is 2 when $n = 2j^2$ and 0 otherwise. □

Proof of Corollary 3.2. (a) The terms of $\Sigma(2)$ with $j \geq 2$ start at x^4, so up to x^3 only the term with $j = 1$ matters. Expanding,

$$\frac{2-x}{1-2x} = (2-x)(1+2x+4x^2+\cdots) = 2+3x+6x^2+\cdots,$$

so $A = 1 + 2x\,(2+3x+6x^2+\cdots) + O(x^4) = 1+4x+6x^2+12x^3+O(x^4)$. This matches the entry, and it gives $a(1) = 4$ and $a(2) = 6$, which contradict the two parts of the conjecture as stated.

(b) For $n > 0$ the conjecture predicts remainder 2 at the squares and 0 elsewhere; by Theorem 3.1 the truth is remainder 2 at the numbers $2j^2$ and 0 elsewhere. No positive integer is both a square and twice a square: if $j^2 = 2k^2$ with $j, k \geq 1$, then $\sqrt{2} = j/k$ would be a fraction, but $\sqrt{2}$ is irrational. So the two descriptions disagree exactly at the squares and at the numbers $2j^2$, and agree everywhere else. □

5 Checking the results

A mathematical proof can contain mistakes, so the results were checked in two independent ways.

Numerical check. We evaluated the two-sided sum in the OEIS name directly, with the terms for negative n computed as Laurent series rather than by folding. This reproduces all 36 terms printed in the entry, including $a(1) = 4$ and $a(2) = 6$. The pattern of Theorem 3.1 holds for every $0 < n < 220$. The computation was done with the PARI/GP computer algebra system, using code that was written separately from the formal proofs (file `verification/independent_checks.gp` in the accompanying repository [9]). A computation can only test finitely many cases, so it is a check on the definitions and on the indexing, not a proof.

Formal proof in Lean. Lean [7] is a *proof assistant*: a program in which mathematical statements and their proofs are written in a precise formal language, and every step is checked mechanically down to the basic rules of logic. All results of this paper are proved in Lean 4 (version 4.19.0) on top of Mathlib [8], Lean's library of formalized mathematics. The statements are collected in the file `lean/Entries/A380680.lean` of the repository, in the namespace `FinalCollection.A380680`. There the one-sided sum $\Sigma(2)$ is written out coefficient by coefficient (only the indices $j \leq n$ can contribute to x^n), and the multiplicative inverse of a series with constant term 1 is written `unitInv`. The folding of the two-sided sum (Lemma 2.1) is proved in this paper but not in Lean. The proofs are in the file `lean/Round4/ThetaRational.lean`. Part (b) of Corollary 3.2 is a direct consequence of the theorem and is not stated separately in Lean. The table lists where each result of this paper is proved.

Statement in this paper	Lean theorem(s)
The defining sum (1), coefficient by coefficient	`explicit_actual_source`
Theorem 3.1: $A \equiv \theta(x^2) \pmod 4$	`complete_series_mod_four`
Theorem 3.1: the two statements for each $n > 0$	`a380680_corrected_statement`
Corollary 3.2(a): $a(1) = 4$, $a(2) = 6$, and both parts of the conjecture are false	`a380680_counterexamples`, `a380680_literal_statement_is_false`, `a380680_complement_is_false`

The Lean project was rebuilt from source for this paper, and Lean was asked to list the basic assumptions (axioms) that each of these theorems ultimately depends on. Every one depends only on the three standard axioms of Lean's logic (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`); no step is left unproved. A formal proof certifies exactly the statement that Lean checks. Whether that statement says what the OEIS entry means is a separate question, so the Lean definitions were also compared, side by side, with the definition in the OEIS entry (Section 1.1).

6 Discussion

How the conjecture went wrong. The conjecture in A380680 is word for word the conjecture of the companion entry A380060, which was contributed on the same day and in which the conjecture is true (see the companion paper in this collection [9]). Replacing the series A by the constant 2 inside the sum looks like a small change, but modulo 2 it is not: the factor $(U - x^j)/(1 - x^j U)$ is 1 when $U \equiv 1 \pmod 2$, and x^j when $U \equiv 0 \pmod 2$. The published terms contradict the conjecture from $n = 1$ on.

Scope. Theorem 3.1 gives the remainder of every coefficient modulo 4. We have not studied higher moduli, and the theorem says nothing about the size of $a(n)$.

A general principle. The two proofs are instances of one observation. Reduction modulo 2 is compatible with all the operations in $\Sigma(U)$, so $\Sigma(U)$ modulo 2 depends only on U modulo 2. By Lemma 2.2, *the remainder of* $1 + 2\Sigma(U)$ *modulo* 4 *depends only on the remainder of* U *modulo* 2. In particular, for every integer series U:

- if $U \equiv 1 \pmod 2$ (odd constant term, all other coefficients even), then $1 + 2\Sigma(U) \equiv \theta(x) \pmod 4$, because $Q_j(1) = 1$;
- if $U \equiv 0 \pmod 2$ (all coefficients even), then $1 + 2\Sigma(U) \equiv \theta(x^2) \pmod 4$, because $Q_j(0) = -x^j$ and $x^{j^2}(-x^j)^j = \pm x^{2j^2}$.

A380060 is the first case with $U = A$ and A380680 is the second case with $U = 2$. We tested both cases numerically on a few other choices of U; this general remark is not part of the Lean formalization.

The method. The proofs illustrate a principle used throughout this collection of papers: a sequence defined by an equation between power series often becomes simple after reduction modulo a small number, and the simple form can be found by a short calculation and then checked.

About this paper

How the work was done. This paper is one of 34 papers on conjectures from the OEIS that came out of an autonomous AI research effort directed by Dev D. Goyal [9]. The roles were as follows.

- *Dev D. Goyal* started the project, chose which problems to pursue, asked for proofs, formal verification and revisions, and decided what to publish. Dev D. Goyal did not supply proof strategies or intermediate arguments.
- *ChatGPT* (OpenAI), using the GPT-6 model with Pro reasoning, worked autonomously from those prompts. It searched the OEIS for suitable conjectures, found the proofs, wrote the Lean 4 formalization, and wrote a first draft of this paper.
- *Claude Opus 5.5*, used with Claude Code, checked the work independently and then rewrote this paper. It rebuilt the Lean project from source and confirmed that the theorems listed in Section 5 rely only on Lean's standard axioms; compared the Lean definitions with the OEIS definition; recomputed the sequence with separately written PARI/GP code, compared it with the terms published in the OEIS, and tested every claim of the paper on many terms; and read every step of the proofs. It then rewrote the text to make it self-contained and readable. The theorems and the proof strategies are ChatGPT's. In rewriting, Claude Opus 5.5 expanded the explanations and, in places, wrote out an argument in more detail or by a more elementary route. The Discussion section was written during this rewrite; the further observations it contains were checked by computer, and they are not part of the Lean formalization.

Dev D. Goyal has verified the results and is responsible for this paper.

Review status. This paper has not been peer reviewed, and it has not been submitted to a journal or to the OEIS.

Priority. An OEIS entry that labels a statement as a conjecture shows only that its contributor did not know a proof; it does not show that no proof existed. During the research only limited searches for earlier work were made. No claim of priority is made.

Corrections. Please report any error in the issue tracker of the repository [9], where the Lean sources, the numerical checks, and the earlier drafts are also available.

Acknowledgements

The sequence and the conjecture are due to Paul D. Hanna [1], who also contributed the companion entry A380060 [2].

References

[1] P. D. Hanna, entry A380680 (G.f. $A(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}(2-x^n)^n/(1-2x^n)^n$), *The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences*, February 2025. `https://oeis.org/A380680`. Text as of October 2026.

[2] P. D. Hanna, entry A380060 (G.f. $A(x)$ satisfies $A(x) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} x^{n^2}(A(x)-x^n)^n/(1-x^nA(x))^n$), *The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences*, February 2025. `https://oeis.org/A380060`. Text as of October 2026.

[3] E. Grosswald, *Representations of Integers as Sums of Squares*, Springer-Verlag, New York, 1985.

[4] N. J. A. Sloane and The OEIS Foundation Inc., *The On-Line Encyclopedia of Integer Sequences*. `https://oeis.org`.

[5] R. P. Stanley, *Enumerative Combinatorics*, Volume 2, Cambridge University Press, 1999. (Chapter 5 treats formal power series, composition and compositional inverses.)

[6] I. Niven, Formal power series, *American Mathematical Monthly* 76 (1969), 871–889.

[7] L. de Moura and S. Ullrich, The Lean 4 theorem prover and programming language, in *Automated Deduction – CADE 28*, Lecture Notes in Computer Science 12699, Springer, 2021, 625–635.

[8] The mathlib Community, The Lean mathematical library, in *Proceedings of the 9th ACM SIGPLAN International Conference on Certified Programs and Proofs (CPP 2020)*, 367–381. Version used: commit `c44e0c8ee63c`.

[9] D. D. Goyal, *Proofs and corrections for 34 OEIS entries, with Lean 4 formalizations*, repository, 2026. `https://github.com/dvgyl/oeis-a396843-proof`.